

MX Linux blazing fast: 10 tweaks that change everything

 incastro.altervista.org/en/mx-linux-optimization-guide

Mike Abbondandolo

February 20, 2026



MX Linux is one of the smartest distributions of 2026: stable, lightweight, and practical. But there's a truth few people mention: **if you configure it properly, it becomes incredibly fast**. If you leave it “stock”, it works fine... but not at its full potential.

This guide is designed for users running **Mini PCs with Intel N100/N150** or **low-power Ryzen CPUs** who want one thing: **real performance**. Less wasted RAM, faster boot, smoother browsing, and a more responsive system overall.

If you need step-by-step installation first, here is the complete guide:  [MX Linux complete guide \(installation + first steps\)](#)



MX Linux Xfce on Mini PC: desktop and performance

Before you start: who really needs this guide

If you are in one of these situations, this page is extremely valuable:

- Mini PC with N100 / N150 and 8–16 GB RAM
- NVMe SSD (or SATA SSD)
- MX Linux Xfce installed with default settings

- You want fewer unnecessary processes and better responsiveness

If instead you want “the latest version of everything” and aggressive updates, MX is not designed for that. MX is about **stability first, problems later**.

1) Fully update the system (the first real performance boost)

It sounds basic, but it’s the foundation for stability and performance. You can do it via GUI or terminal:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt upgrade -y
```

If you want deeper context about kernel improvements and hardware support, read also:

👉 [Linux 6.18: faster, safer and ready for modern hardware](#)

2) Install Flatpak + Flathub (modern apps without breaking the system)

This alone changes everything: access to modern apps without messing with unstable repositories.

```
sudo apt install flatpak -y
flatpak remote-add --if-not-exists flathub
https://flathub.org/repo/flathub.flatpakrepo
```

Complete Linux app installation guide: 👉 [How to install applications on Linux](#)

3) Reduce swap usage (Swappiness tweak)

On Mini PCs with 8–16GB RAM, reducing swap usage improves responsiveness.

```
echo 'vm.swappiness=10' | sudo tee /etc/sysctl.d/99-swappiness.conf
sudo sysctl -p /etc/sysctl.d/99-swappiness.conf
```

Real-world result: **fewer micro-lags when multitasking**.

4) Enable ZRAM (more effective RAM, faster multitasking)

ZRAM compresses RAM and improves multitasking responsiveness, especially on Mini PCs.

```
sudo apt install zram-tools -y
```

Result: **less disk swap, faster system response**.

 MX Linux RAM usage and responsiveness

5) Disable compositor (for maximum smoothness)

- Settings → Window Manager Tweaks
- Compositor tab → Disable compositing

Result: fewer visual effects, maximum performance.

6) Clean startup applications

Settings → Session and Startup → Application Autostart

Disable unnecessary apps for better responsiveness.

7) Enable TRIM on SSD

```
systemctl status fstrim.timer
```

```
sudo systemctl enable --now fstrim.timer
```

This maintains SSD performance over time.

8) Optimize browser performance

- Enable hardware acceleration
- Use adblocker
- Limit extensions

Hardware selection guide: 👉 [Mini PC with Linux: pros and cons](#)

9) Use MX Tools

- Drivers
- Maintenance
- Repositories
- Backup and snapshots

This is one of MX Linux's biggest strengths.

10) Update wisely

- Update regularly
- Use Flatpak for modern apps
- Create backups

MX Linux optimized becomes extremely fast

With these tweaks, MX Linux becomes fast, stable and efficient.

Complete installation guide: 🖱️ [MX Linux complete guide](#)